

The Backyard Sound Song

Easy start · Outdoors · Kid can lead · Ages 5–9 · 20 min

Brought to you by Stacey — “If it makes a sound, it can make a song.”

Sit still outside for four minutes, collect every sound you hear, then turn the list into a song.

WHAT YOU NEED

- Somewhere outside to sit
- Paper and a pencil
- Optional: cups, a box, a comb, anything that makes a noise

BEFORE YOU START

Stay within sight of a grown-up.

If you are near a road, sit facing away from it and stay behind a fence or gate.

How to make it

- 1 Sit down outside and close your eyes for a slow count of sixty.
- 2 Open your eyes and write down every sound you can still remember hearing.
- 3 Go back and listen again, this time for sounds you missed. Add them to the list.
- 4 Next to each sound, write whether it was long or short, high or low, once or over and over.
- 5 Make each sound yourself using your voice, your hands, or something from the kitchen.
- 6 Put four of them in an order that repeats, and you have a song. Perform it for somebody.

TALK ABOUT IT

Which sound was hardest to notice, and why do you think you missed it the first time?

TRY THIS TOO

Record the same spot at a different time of day. Which sounds vanished and which new ones arrived?

DID YOU KNOW? · SOUND & RHYTHM

Animals use sound to send messages. Birds call to warn each other, to claim a spot, and to find a partner. The call is short and repeated so it carries a long way and is easy to recognize. Your ears just did the same job a listening bird does.